

1. The names of everyone in your group and their TA's name

Eli Werstler, Noah Bernstein, Jack Lobel – Jennifer
Riley Chapuis – Jonah

2. A breakdown of the individual responsibilities/assigned tasks for each group member

Eli Werstler	The corporate crossover from spiritually charged music based in rebellious ideology to a globalized, multi-billion-dollar industry. Originally, hip hop founded a culture rooted in community, but gradually shifted to a global, hyper-commercialized commodity.
Riley Chapuis	Personal brands, purchased entry into the hip hop community, association of values and beliefs (e.g. Yeezy)
Noah Bernstein	Production → Def Jam, specifically Rick Rubin, using elements of rock production (one subversive genre) to promote the commercial success of hip hop (another subversive genre)
Jack Lobel	Management

3. Briefly explain the form your portfolio "chapters" / "primary sources" will take. Will they be songs, videos, fashion photographs, visual artworks, media coverage (i.e., newspaper or magazine stories), etc. Will you be gathering these materials, making your own, or both?

Because I'm going to get into the commercialization of hip-hop and rappers associating themselves with brands, my sources will mainly be oriented around advertisements and commercials. I'll also get into how media coverage has shifted across the years as hip-hop has become more and more mainstream and commercialized. Lastly, I think I'll incorporate some fashion photography/videos showing the shift from community oriented fashion and colors to luxury personal branding.

4. A short preliminary answer to each of the following questions:

How will the project explore the intersection of Hip Hop and Religion?

The project will examine the shift from communal, church-style spiritualism to worshipping success. Wealth accumulation and corporate ownership became its own form of secular faith, with listeners idolizing rappers, aspiring to achieve the wealth that rappers associate themselves with.

How will the project engage at least three different artists/groups/albums, or, if you opted to focus on a single artist/group, engage at least three different albums by the chosen artist?

I'm planning on analyzing Wu-Tang Clan's *Enter the Wu-Tang*, 50 Cent's *Get Rich or Die Tryin'*, and Jay Z's *4:44*. These should cover communalism, materialistic hustle, and generational wealth through rap and brand building, respectively.

How will the project examine at least three decades (between the 1970s and the 2020s)?

The project will track the 90s era of street-spiritual identity, the 2000s pivot to hyper-commercialized bling culture, and 2010s-20s era of artists being global financial moguls.

How will the project analyze specific songs, albums, videos, etc?

I will analyze lyrics of the aforementioned sources and more, showing the shift over time in the way artists approach writing songs in the context of commercialism. I'll also show corporate branding within the music, and more explicit brand deals, like in commercials.

How will the project locate the artist(s) and sources engaged in the paper/project within their broader social world and historical context (i.e., What do these artists/songs/albums tell us about the 1980s)?

I think this shift is based in the politics of abandonment, where maybe failure of the state forced youth into different forms of radical entrepreneurship to succeed. I'll show how commercializing became a necessary strategy for disadvantaged people to try to compete in today's world.

5. Any questions your group still has about the project (if you have them)

Would it be okay if there is a little overlap between group members, including overlapping sources or points being made, or should all be fully independent while contributing to a common goal?